

How to partition your hard drive?



What is a partition?

If you're new to the field of computers, these are some of the questions you'd be asking your acquaintances. A disk partition or disk division is performed to manage all your documents, media, and valuable data in such a manner so that you don't lose any of your stuff in the event of a crash. This makes your data classified in separate drives avoiding any duplication and accidental loss. Okay enough with the all serious 'definition' of what's what!. The name 'disk partition' is self explanatory to understand what it is. Still, average PC users find it difficult to go about with whole procedure.

Most users use an XP machine so lets look at a simpler way of dividing these siamese twins to put them for a better use.

How to do it?

No matter how you plan to partition your hard drive, a part of it has to be dedicated for your operating system. In this case all your system files (those which run your PC) program files (files belonging to software that you install) will be saved. It is advised that you do not store or install any unwanted/experimental data here because it's from here that you run your system. You shouldn't be messing around with it. Let's take a look at how you could partition your disk on new installations, and then how you could add a second hard disk to your existing system.

For new installations

Insert the operating system setup CD or DVD in your drive. You might be prompted to remove this CD/DVD and insert additional disks during installation depending on the kind of disk you are using. Restart your PC to begin with the setup program. The setup will detect that XP is already installed on the system and would ask if you want to repair it. Bypass this step by pressing Esc, on the top left of your keyboard.

A list of all existing disks partitioned or non partitioned will appear use the arrow key to move on and select the desired disk. Use the following keys to go around with the partitioning business: C - if you want to create a new partition on a non partitioned disk space

D - if you wish to delete any existing partition press L to confirm deletion

Enter Key - Use the enter key to create partition with the maximum size. Type the desired size in MB to specify the size of partition



Remember that you should delete any existing partitions on a disk space if you want to create new partition/partitions in that particular space. Continue with the installation once you have made your partition settings.

Adding a hard drive

If you have installed a new hard drive in your system you might want to create partitions in it this is how you do it. Open Control panel, select classic view to list all the icons, click on Administrative Tools then select Computer management upon clicking this option a popup window will appear. On the left side of this window expand the Storage option and select Disk Management. The following popup window will appear.

From this window you can simply right click on the desired/new drive, and add, delete, format according suiting your needs.^[d]

